Paragate — Narrative Kinematics Report

Generated from manuscript ADTM data using the StoryNK model. M = Magnitude / premise alignment (legacy V / Vector).

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Story	Units	Position Span
Paragate	53	571 - 56,806

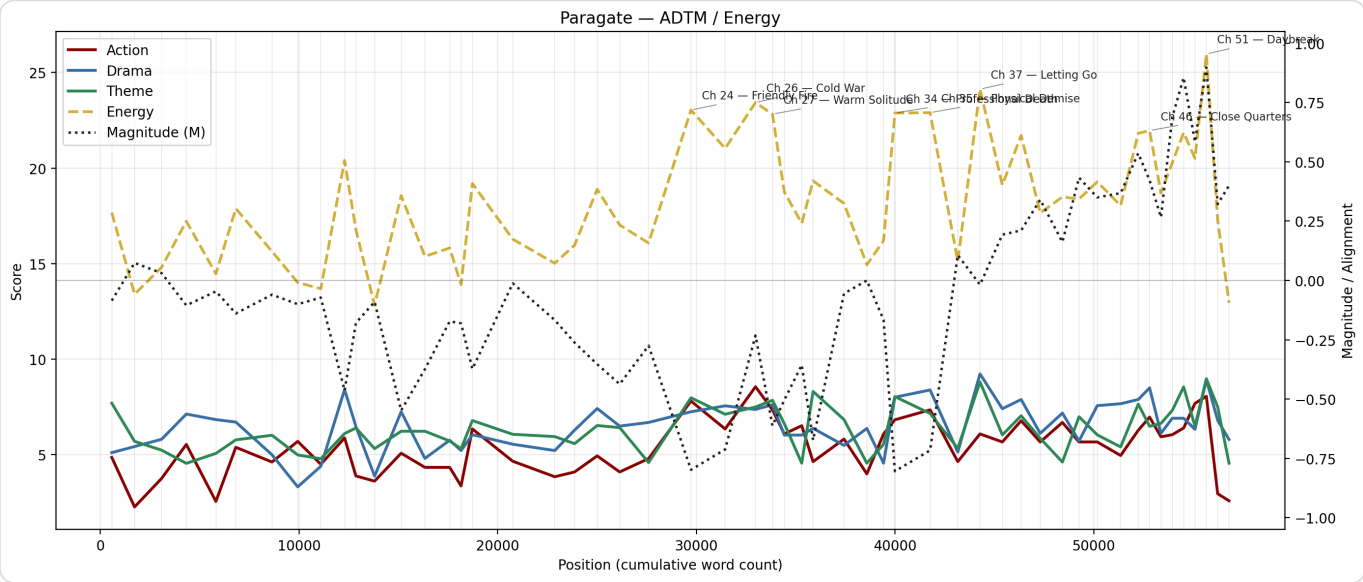
Mean Energy	Mean Magnitude	Mean Premise Force
18.20	-0.055	-0.34

Peak Energy: Ch 51 — Daybreak
Peak Gravity: Ch 51 — Daybreak
Peak Premise Load: Ch 51 — Daybreak
Highest Cut Risk: Ch 53 — Threaded Echoes

System Overview

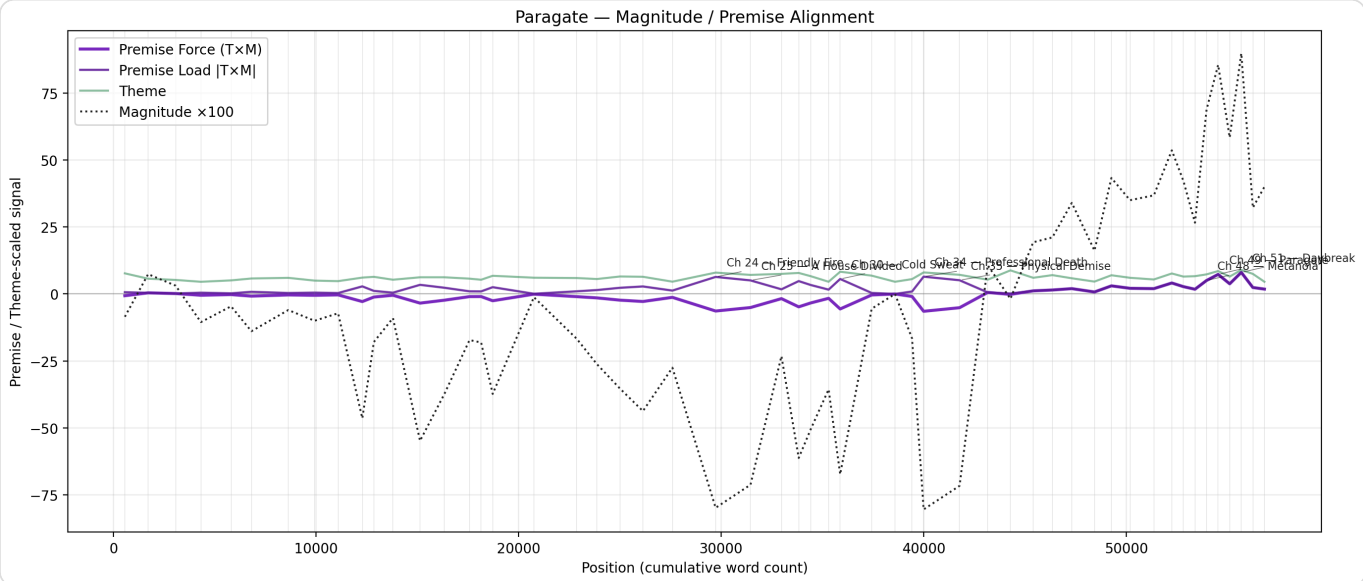
Action, Drama, and Theme define the primary narrative magnitude fields. Magnitude (M) tracks premise alignment, with negative values leaning toward anti-truth and positive values leaning toward governing truth. Energy is A + D + T. Premise Force is T × M. Steady-state and transient tracks approximate long-wave baseline versus local fluctuation. Narrative Mass, Peak Prominence, and Narrative Gravity estimate which regions are merely loud versus which ones are actually load-bearing.

ADTM / Energy Landscape

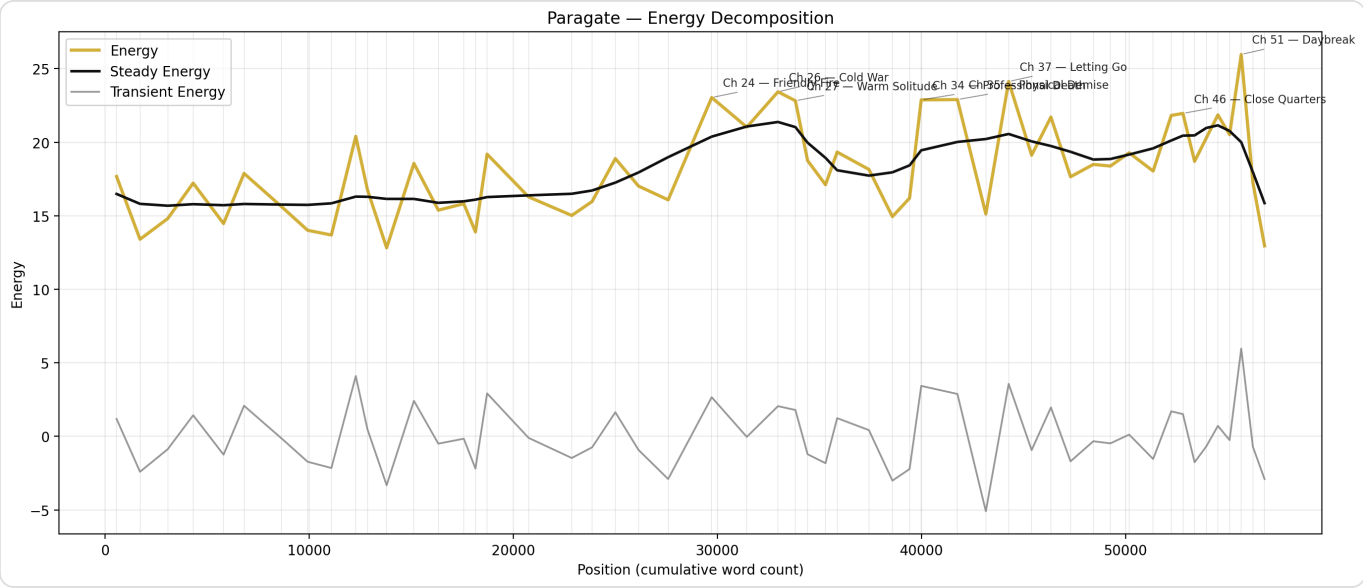


Action, Drama, Theme, Energy, and Magnitude across cumulative story position.

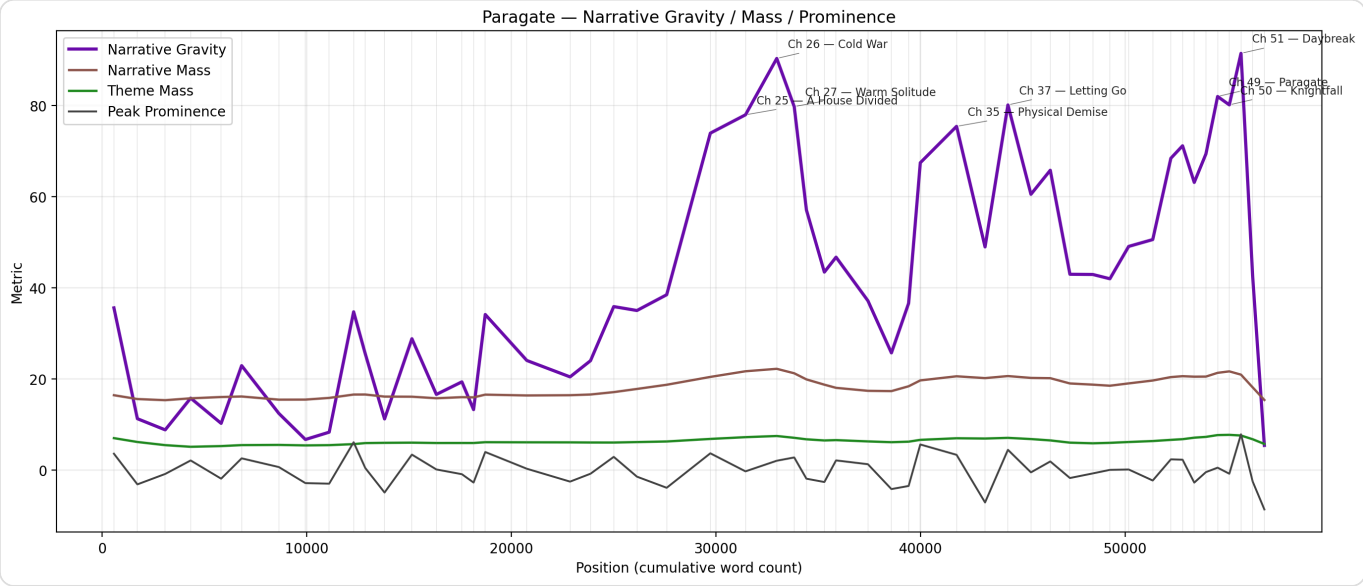
Magnitude / Premise Alignment



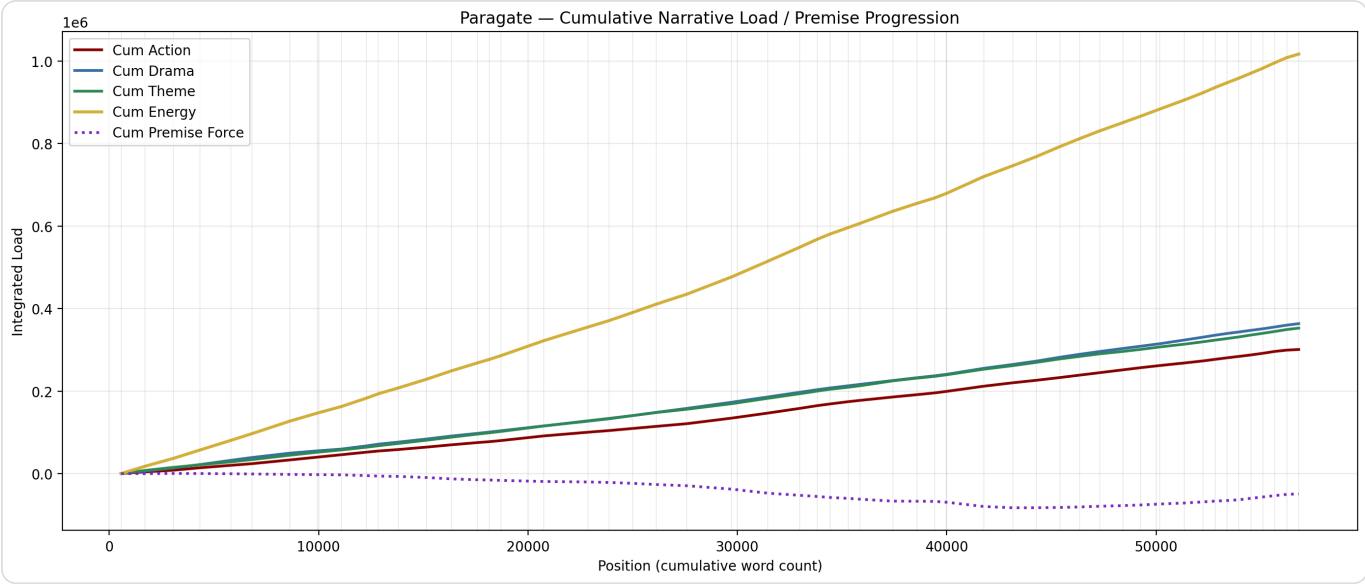
Magnitude, Premise Force (T×M), and Premise Load |T×M| across the manuscript.



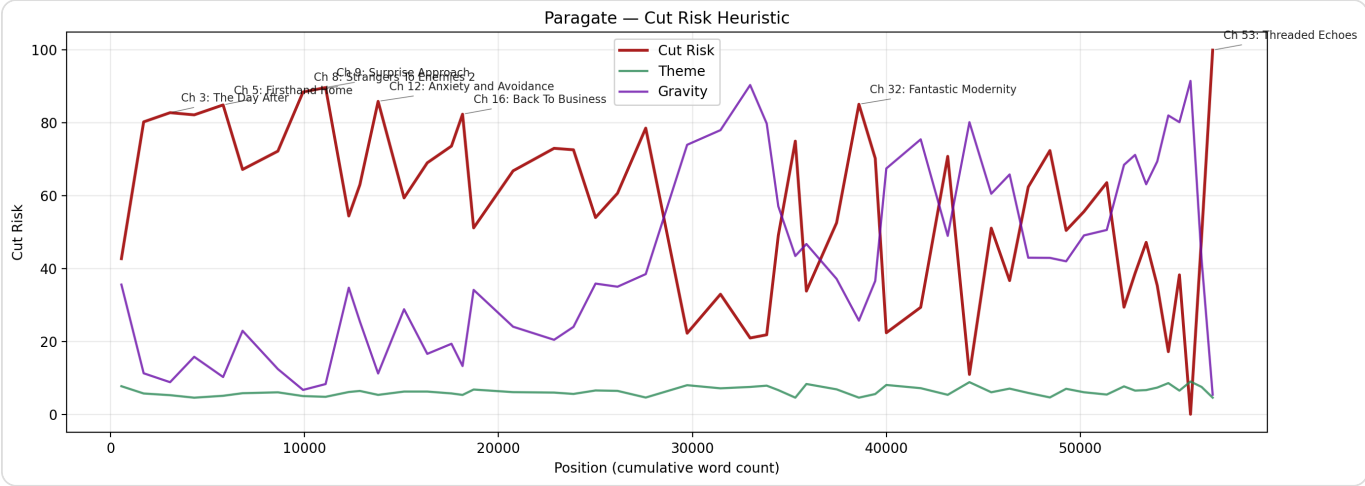
Composite Energy versus steady-state and transient energy behavior.



Narrative Gravity, Mass, Theme Mass, and Peak Prominence.



Cumulative action, drama, theme, energy, and premise progression.



Cut-risk heuristic versus theme and gravity.

Top Gravity Peaks

Ch 51 — Daybreak

Gravity: 91.45 | **Energy:** 25.97 | **M:** +0.90 | **PF:** +8.06 | **POV:** Katiya

Setting: Unspecified | Unspecified | Unspecified

Summary: Katiya confronts the living shape of her oldest trauma and proves that what she has learned is stronger than fear. As Nhytyx recreates the emotional architecture of the nightmare that once broke her, Katiya saves her family through action instead of paralysis, while Cody disobeys her only enough to make one small but crucial difference. At dawn, Katiya completes her arc not just by surviving the past, but by replacing it with a new public truth.

Blurb: At the edge of dawn, courage means returning to the exact place fear was born.

Katiya reaches the burning district and finds Nhytyx leading the same kind of horror that defined her childhood trauma: except Endogeny is present (Firebrand). For one terrible bea...

Ch 26 — Cold War

Gravity: 90.32 | **Energy:** 23.43 | **M:** -0.23 | **PF:** -1.74 | **POV:** Cody

Setting: Unspecified | Unspecified | Unspecified | 2015-10-03

Summary: Jackson's "Operation Bluewings" flashback: drone crash, mission abort, and his sacrificial call to Overwatch in the storm.

Blurb: Years earlier, in a storm of ice and static, a mission hangs by a thread.

It's the cold snap that brings him back again.

Ch 49 — Paragate

Gravity: 81.98 | **Energy:** 21.86 | **M:** +0.85 | **PF:** +7.31 | **POV:** Katiya, Cody

Setting: Unspecified | Unspecified | Unspecified

Summary: The true conflict of Paragate begins as witness replaces doubt and preparation replaces denial. Aldrin sees enough to gamble on Katiya, while Cody leaves Navidson-Monroe uncertain of what his honesty has bought him but sure he is not done yet. Both protagonists step fully into the roles they have been resisting, and the story pivots from argument into mobilization.

Blurb: Once the truth is seen with open eyes, the only question left is whether anyone can move fast enough.

Katiya brings Aldrin face-to-face with the reality of the approaching threat, and Jade and Aliaki reinforce what she has forced him to witness. When the Royal Knights arrive, Aldri...

Ch 50 — Knightfall

Gravity: 80.13 | **Energy:** 20.51 | **M:** +0.58 | **PF:** +3.79 | **POV:** Cody, Katiya

Setting: Unspecified | Unspecified | Unspecified

Summary: The battle turns when Cody is the first to notice movement across the frozen lake and realizes the defense is pointed the wrong way. As the first line is held by powers and allies beyond the core cast, the

real threat reveals itself as a coordinated strike against the city itself. Katiya is forced into the exact shape of the nightmare that made her who she is, and Cody refuses to leave her to face it entirely alone.

Blurb: Winter arrives with teeth just when the defenses start to hold.

Watching the drone feed, Cody spots enemy figures crossing the lake and realizes the defenses are no longer where they need to be. When comms fail, he leaves the drone idling and r...

Ch 37 — Letting Go

Gravity: 80.12 | **Energy:** 24.13 | **M:** -0.02 | **PF:** -0.16 | **POV:** Katiya, Cody

Setting: Valenseia | Hillfar | Unspecified | 2026-12-01

Summary:

Blurb: Shame, buried memories, and unexpected visitors push both worlds toward a new kind of war.

"She was trying to save him," Jullian says. "Bertram left and we did nothing — but it was Katiya that was braver than all of us!"

Ch 27 — Warm Solitude

Gravity: 79.76 | **Energy:** 22.82 | **M:** -0.61 | **PF:** -4.80 | **POV:** Katiya

Setting: Valenseia | Hillfar | The Shortwall | 2005-08-23

Summary: Katiya's origin trauma: childhood game ? treehouse collapse ? Raph's death; she hides in a corpse pit; the Chymaeran lie brands her forever.

Blurb: Long before today, a childhood dare turned into a scar that never closed.

"Why is it so hard for you to let go?" The question comes from thirty feet below.

Ch 25 — A House Divided

Gravity: 77.95 | **Energy:** 21.03 | **M:** -0.71 | **PF:** -5.07 | **POV:** Cody, Katiya

Setting: Colorado | Evergreen Estates | Cody's House | 2026-07-07

Summary: Cody spirals home; Katiya waits on his couch; their mutual failures ignite a bitter fight—door slammed shut again.

Blurb: Back at the house, two people who need comfort get conflict instead.

Sometimes this numbness can be a blessing in the same way that it's a curse.

Ch 35 — Physical Demise

Gravity: 75.42 | **Energy:** 22.90 | **M:** -0.72 | **PF:** -5.13 | **POV:** Katiya

Setting: Valenseia | Gaffesend | Guards' Quarter | 2026-11-30

Summary:

Blurb: Desperation pulls Katiya beyond the walls, where duty, grief, and old ghosts converge.

It's a new feeling that finds me when I'm rushing through the open streets, one I felt the day before when I heard Cody's voice cheering my name. It's an energy that races my circu...

Top Energy Peaks

Ch 51 — Daybreak

Energy: 25.97 | **Energy:** 25.97 | **M:** +0.90 | **PF:** +8.06 | **POV:** Katiya

Setting: Unspecified | Unspecified | Unspecified

Summary: Katiya confronts the living shape of her oldest trauma and proves that what she has learned is stronger than fear. As Nhytyx recreates the emotional architecture of the nightmare that once broke her, Katiya saves her family through action instead of paralysis, while Cody disobeys her only enough to make one small but crucial difference. At dawn, Katiya completes her arc not just by surviving the past, but by replacing it with a new public truth.

Blurb: At the edge of dawn, courage means returning to the exact place fear was born.

Katiya reaches the burning district and finds Nhytyx leading the same kind of horror that defined her childhood trauma: except Endogeny is present (Firebrand). For one terrible bea...

Ch 37 — Letting Go

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Setting: Valenseia | Hillfar | Unspecified | 2026-12-01

Summary:

Blurb: Shame, buried memories, and unexpected visitors push both worlds toward a new kind of war.

"She was trying to save him," Jullian says. "Bertram left and we did nothing — but it was Katiya that was braver than all of us!"

Ch 26 — Cold War

Energy: 23.43 | **Energy:** 23.43 | **M:** -0.23 | **PF:** -1.74 | **POV:** Cody

Setting: Unspecified | Unspecified | Unspecified | 2015-10-03

Summary: Jackson's "Operation Bluewings" flashback: drone crash, mission abort, and his sacrificial call to Overwatch in the storm.

Blurb: Years earlier, in a storm of ice and static, a mission hangs by a thread.

It's the cold snap that brings him back again.

Ch 24 — Friendly Fire

Energy: 23.04 | **Energy:** 23.04 | **M:** -0.80 | **PF:** -6.37 | **POV:** Cody, Katiya

Setting: Colorado | Shaleborough | Navidson-Monroe Aerospace | 2026-07-07

Summary: Reed's presentation wins; Cody's mild critique is spun as jealousy and he snaps publicly; Katiya loses to Aryn, is told she's below the line, and learns her family's already in Gaffesend.

Blurb: One wins the crowd; the other loses control. Lines are drawn on both sides.

Reed's entirely prepared as he advances towards his last slide. In the lower corner, it reads 20 OF 20: even with a custom progress bar to show the stages of his presentation.

Ch 35 — Physical Demise

Energy: 22.90 | **Energy:** 22.90 | **M:** -0.72 | **PF:** -5.13 | **POV:** Katiya

Setting: Valenseia | Gaffesend | Guards' Quarter | 2026-11-30

Summary:

Blurb: Desperation pulls Katiya beyond the walls, where duty, grief, and old ghosts converge.

It's a new feeling that finds me when I'm rushing through the open streets, one I felt the day before when I heard Cody's voice cheering my name. It's an energy that races my circu...

Ch 34 — Professional Death

Energy: 22.88 | **Energy:** 22.88 | **M:** -0.80 | **PF:** -6.46 | **POV:** Cody

Setting: Colorado | Evergreen Estates | Navidson-Monroe Aerospace | 2026-11-30

Summary:

Blurb: At work, a meeting becomes a reckoning. Someone steps forward, and the cost is real.

When I rose from four hours of sleep, I found that same feeling of dread I found in college when the world finally caught up with me, when I remembered it was a heavy day of finals...

Largest Premise Loads

Ch 51 — Daybreak

PremiseLoad: 8.06 | **Energy:** 25.97 | **M:** +0.90 | **PF:** +8.06 | **POV:** Katiya

Setting: Unspecified | Unspecified | Unspecified

Summary: Katiya confronts the living shape of her oldest trauma and proves that what she has learned is stronger than fear. As Nhytyx recreates the emotional architecture of the nightmare that once broke her, Katiya saves her family through action instead of paralysis, while Cody disobeys her only enough to make one small but crucial difference. At dawn, Katiya completes her arc not just by surviving the past, but by replacing it with a new public truth.

Blurb: At the edge of dawn, courage means returning to the exact place fear was born.

Katiya reaches the burning district and finds Nhytyx leading the same kind of horror that defined her childhood trauma: except Endogeny is present (Firebrand). For one terrible bea...

Ch 49 — Paragate

PremiseLoad: 7.31 | **Energy:** 21.86 | **M:** +0.85 | **PF:** +7.31 | **POV:** Katiya, Cody

Setting: Unspecified | Unspecified | Unspecified

Summary: The true conflict of Paragate begins as witness replaces doubt and preparation replaces denial. Aldrin sees enough to gamble on Katiya, while Cody leaves Navidson-Monroe uncertain of what his honesty has bought him but sure he is not done yet. Both protagonists step fully into the roles they have been resisting, and the story pivots from argument into mobilization.

Blurb: Once the truth is seen with open eyes, the only question left is whether anyone can move fast enough.

Katiya brings Aldrin face-to-face with the reality of the approaching threat, and Jade and Aliaki reinforce what she has forced him to witness. When the Royal Knights arrive, Aldri...

Ch 34 — Professional Death

PremiseLoad: 6.46 | **Energy:** 22.88 | **M:** -0.80 | **PF:** -6.46 | **POV:** Cody

Setting: Colorado | Evergreen Estates | Navidson-Monroe Aerospace | 2026-11-30

Summary:

Blurb: At work, a meeting becomes a reckoning. Someone steps forward, and the cost is real.

When I rose from four hours of sleep, I found that same feeling of dread I found in college when the world finally caught up with me, when I remembered it was a heavy day of finals...

Ch 24 — Friendly Fire

PremiseLoad: 6.37 | **Energy:** 23.04 | **M:** -0.80 | **PF:** -6.37 | **POV:** Cody, Katiya

Setting: Colorado | Shaleborough | Navidson-Monroe Aerospace | 2026-07-07

Summary: Reed's presentation wins; Cody's mild critique is spun as jealousy and he snaps publicly; Katiya loses to Aryn, is told she's below the line, and learns her family's already in

Gaffesend.

Blurb: One wins the crowd; the other loses control. Lines are drawn on both sides.

Reed's entirely prepared as he advances towards his last slide. In the lower corner, it reads 20 OF 20: even with a custom progress bar to show the stages of his presentation.

Ch 30 — Cold Sweat

PremiseLoad: 5.59 | **Energy:** 19.33 | **M:** -0.67 | **PF:** -5.59 | **POV:** Katiya, Cody

Setting: Valenseia | Gaffesend | Lake Garrison | 2026-11-27

Summary:

Blurb: New alliances form while an ominous email threatens Cody's career.

They say to never challenge an Ahkvasan to a foot race: you might be faster, but you still won't get there in time.

Ch 35 — Physical Demise

PremiseLoad: 5.13 | **Energy:** 22.90 | **M:** -0.72 | **PF:** -5.13 | **POV:** Katiya

Setting: Valenseia | Gaffesend | Guards' Quarter | 2026-11-30

Summary:

Blurb: Desperation pulls Katiya beyond the walls, where duty, grief, and old ghosts converge.

It's a new feeling that finds me when I'm rushing through the open streets, one I felt the day before when I heard Cody's voice cheering my name. It's an energy that races my circu...

Ch 25 — A House Divided

PremiseLoad: 5.07 | **Energy:** 21.03 | **M:** -0.71 | **PF:** -5.07 | **POV:** Cody, Katiya

Setting: Colorado | Evergreen Estates | Cody's House | 2026-07-07

Summary: Cody spirals home; Katiya waits on his couch; their mutual failures ignite a bitter fight—door slammed shut again.

Blurb: Back at the house, two people who need comfort get conflict instead.

Sometimes this numbness can be a blessing in the same way that it's a curse.

Ch 48 — Metanoia

PremiseLoad: 5.04 | **Energy:** 20.28 | **M:** +0.69 | **PF:** +5.04 | **POV:** Cody, Katiya

Setting: Unspecified | Unspecified | Unspecified

Summary: Both protagonists fight for one clean chance to be heard. Cody's confession turns his firing into a political problem inside Navidson-Monroe, while Katiya persuades Aryn that the truth matters more than procedure and turns imprisonment into a joint push toward Aldrin. The chapter tests what they have actually learned: not how to escape pressure, but how to move through it without lying to themselves.

Blurb: Some doors open because you're invited. The important ones never do.

Cody is pulled into a glass conference room where HR tries to reduce him to a clean termination case, with Reed present as witness. Cody refuses to sign, clears his father, and for...

Highest Cut-Risk Units

Ch 53 — Threaded Echoes

CutRisk: 99.91 | **Energy:** 12.95 | **M:** +0.40 | **PF:** +1.82 | **POV:** Default

Setting: Unspecified | Unspecified | Unspecified

Summary:

Blurb: Titus' past catches up with him.

In the only Titus-perspective scene of the book, Ellie reveals a memory, gesture, or contradiction that should not be possible. The moment leaves Titus with the terrible understand...

Ch 9 — Surprise Approach

CutRisk: 89.63 | **Energy:** 13.69 | **M:** -0.07 | **PF:** -0.34 | **POV:** Cody

Setting: Colorado | Evergreen Estates | Cody's House | 2026-04-26

Summary: Cody tries to rationalize it away (no wound); barricades the door; nearly late to work; meets foil Reed.

Blurb: Cody barricades more than a door as reality refuses to make sense.

Late Sunday morning, around 11:00, I awoke with my neck twisted against the closet door, my face saturated with drool, shirt missing, and a sticky note taped to my forehead with Mi...

Ch 8 — Strangers To Enemies 2

CutRisk: 88.42 | **Energy:** 14.01 | **M:** -0.10 | **PF:** -0.50 | **POV:** Katiya

Setting: Valenseia | Gaffesend | Katiya's House | 2026-04-25

Summary: Third clash: Katiya (assuming Auvryan assassin) and Cody fight to another misunderstanding; she drives him back through the door.

Blurb: Misread motives turn their encounter into a full-on clash.

I wager my strength and power over his defenses. The inebriated man called Cody holds the odd, metallic broomstick with his hands together in the center — a technique I've never se...

Ch 12 — Anxiety and Avoidance

CutRisk: 85.85 | **Energy:** 12.82 | **M:** -0.09 | **PF:** -0.48 | **POV:** Katiya

Setting: Valenseia | Gaffesend | Guards' Quarter | 2026-05-22

Summary: FOUR WEEK TIME SKIPKatiya, Ryder, and Paxton rescue near-dead Bertram; she's blamed and shut out—her only remaining lifeline is Cody.

Blurb: With help scarce, Katiya runs toward the only lifeline left.

Calling his name will do nothing. I decide ahead of time to break in instead of patiently knocking, hoping the others piece together my purpose for panic instead of thinking I'm ju...

Ch 32 — Fantastic Modernity

CutRisk: 85.05 | **Energy:** 14.94 | **M:** +0.00 | **PF:** +0.00 | **POV:** Katiya, Cody
Setting: Colorado | Evergreen Estates | Cody's House | 2026-11-29

Summary:

Blurb: Katiya's first peaceful sleep leads straight into chaotic, sword-filled "fantasy" tourism on Earth.

Even in another world, I can't escape the same dream. The only difference is that sleep comes faster on a bed that's made of clouds, instead of one made from horsehair and feathers...

Ch 5 — Firsthand Home

CutRisk: 84.87 | **Energy:** 14.47 | **M:** -0.05 | **PF:** -0.23 | **POV:** Cody
Setting: Colorado | Evergreen Estates | Cody's House | 2026-04-24

Summary: Cody + Miguel bro out, drink hard; Miguel crashes, Cody stays up.

Blurb: Drinks with a best friend turn into confessions—and an idea Cody should ignore.

"Since you started on your first day, you haven't been drug tested. What's gonna change their mind on Monday, bro? My work never runs drug tests," he says. Gunfire cracks over the...

Ch 3 — The Day After

CutRisk: 82.74 | **Energy:** 14.81 | **M:** +0.03 | **PF:** +0.16 | **POV:** Cody
Setting: Colorado | Shaleborough | Navidson-Monroe Aerospace | 2026-04-24

Summary: Cody's bleak office day: roasted for late redlines, awkward beat with Kei, then family unpacking with Miguel queued up for drinks.

Blurb: Another soul-numbing office day pushes Cody toward a choice he's not ready to make.

I realize I'm done working on the redline when my hands stop moving. Copying changes from a red-inked engineering drawing to the computer is easy enough to get lost in thought. The...

Ch 16 — Back To Business

CutRisk: 82.33 | **Energy:** 13.90 | **M:** -0.18 | **PF:** -0.96 | **POV:** Cody
Setting: Colorado | Shaleborough | Navidson-Monroe Aerospace | 2026-05-25

Summary: Cody's spark flickers: nostalgia and lunch with Alan (Jackson talk); he returns hoping for an open door.

Blurb: A lunch with Dad. A memory of a brother. A door that might be open tonight.

"I think that will work just fine," Reed says. "What do you think?"

LLM Revision Diagnosis

Length assessment: 53 chapters is viable for a double-novel structure, but the book is currently over-distributed in the middle and early sections. The back third carries the clearest structural mass; the front third spends too long proving the mirror gimmick and not enough time consolidating it into forward motion.
Structural health: Uneven but salvageable. The story does build real mountains, especially in late Act 3 through Act 4, and it lands a legitimate climax at Chapter 51. The main structural weakness is that several mirrored dual-protagonist beats read like duplication rather than escalation, creating local stalls and false plateaus.
Premise alignment: Mixed. The endgame is strongly premise-aligned, but the storywide mean magnitude is slightly negative and many early/mid chapters sit near zero or drift negative without converting that drift into sharp thematic consequence. The book knows what it is at the end more than it knows what it is in the first half.
Distribution health: Back-loaded. Act 1 has too many high-cut-risk, low-gravity chapters. Act 2 improves but still meanders. Act 3 has major payload but also a drag pocket around 29-33. Act 4 is the healthiest sustained run, though a few chapters are louder than they are aligned.
Primary strength: When the two-protagonist mirror structure stops being a formal pattern and becomes a convergent engine of mutual change, the novel works. Chapters 24-27, 34-35, 45, 49, and especially 51 show the premise firing on all cylinders.
Primary risk: The mirrored double-novel design is causing repetition drag. Too many paired beats deliver 'equivalent trouble in both worlds' without enough new strategic information, premise movement, or irreversible consequence. That makes some chapters feel busy, emotional, and even well-written while still structurally skippable.

This is not a broken book. It is a book with a real climax, real thematic spine, and a late-game convergence that finally justifies the dual-protagonist premise. But the first half and parts of the middle are too tolerant of mirrored scene logic for its own sake. A lot of chapters are not dead; they are redundant, under-aligned, or stuck near magnitude zero while pretending to be major movement. Revision should focus on compressing repetitive mirror beats, clarifying major magnitude turns, and making every Cody/Katiya pairing do non-overlapping work. Protect the late Act 4 run and the trauma-confrontation climax. Be much harsher on Act 1 drag, the 29-33 corridor, and the epilogue tag.

Protect at All Costs

- Chapter 24
- Chapter 27
- Chapter 34
- Chapter 35

- Chapter 49
- Chapter 51

Strongest Regions

Ch 51 — Daybreak

Reason: This is the unquestionable structural summit: peak energy, peak gravity, peak premise force, zero cheapness, and a clean positive magnitude of 0.898. It resolves Katiya's deepest wound in direct contact with the story's premise.
Revision instruction: Protect the chapter's core design. Only revise for clarity, setup callback density, and ensuring Cody's contribution remains crucial but subordinate to Katiya's earned completion.

Ch 49 — Paragate

Reason: This is the cleanest convergence chapter before climax: very high theme, very high positive magnitude, very low ambiguity, low cheapness. The novel finally pivots from argument to mobilization in premise terms.
Revision instruction: Sharpen this as the point of no return. Make sure both protagonists make distinct, irreversible commitments rather than parallel versions of the same beat.

Ch 24 — Friendly Fire

Reason: Strong negative-polarity premise hit. High energy, high theme, strong magnitude alignment, low ambiguity. It looks like one of the best 'downward turn' chapters in the book.
Revision instruction: Keep the dual collapse, but ensure the mirrored defeats are causally and symbolically linked rather than merely simultaneous.

Ch 34 — Professional Death

Reason: One of the strongest Cody-side premise chapters: high theme, strong negative magnitude, low ambiguity, low cheapness. It feels like real structural damage rather than noise.
Revision instruction: Protect the consequences. Make later Cody recovery clearly pay off this exact humiliation and cost.

Ch 27 — Warm Solitude

Reason: Katiya's origin-trauma material carries real mass and strong premise load. This is foundational negative alignment that feeds the climax effectively.
Revision instruction: Keep it, but tighten any exposition that does not directly wire this trauma to later action in Chapters 37 and 51.

Drag Corridors

Ch 2–9

Problem: early mirror-drag / weak premise traction | **Confidence:** 0.96

Reason: Act 1 contains multiple high-cut-risk chapters with low gravity and low |M|: 2, 3, 5, 8, 9 especially. The dual introductions and repeated misunderstanding beats establish symmetry, but too often they do not escalate premise force. Chapters 7-9 in particular look like replays of the same cross-world confusion.
Suggested fix: Compress repeated introduction/misunderstanding material. Combine or trim mirrored beats so each pass across the door changes the relationship, rules, or stakes in a non-redundant way. Keep the initial wonder/disorientation, but stop restating it.

Ch 14–20

Problem: mid-Act 2 soft drift | **Confidence:** 0.74
Reason: This span is not disastrous, but several chapters have middling gravity and elevated cut risk while hovering in modestly negative or near-neutral premise territory. The double-novel sightseeing/date/training material risks feeling like parallel lifestyle content rather than mounting conflict.
Suggested fix: For every paired Cody/Katiya beat, assign one chapter to relational advancement and the other to strategic cost. If a chapter only deepens vibe or chemistry, compress it into a more consequential scene.

Ch 29–33

Problem: major drag corridor / premise blur | **Confidence:** 0.99
Reason: This is the clearest middle stall. Chapter 29 is extremely cheap in both action and drama with very high cut risk. Chapter 31 has high thematic ambiguity near zero magnitude. Chapter 32 drops to M=0 with huge cut risk and cheap heat. Chapter 33 is also cut-risky and cheap-action-heavy. This reads like a run where movement is happening, but the novel's vector is not.
Suggested fix: Compress this whole block aggressively. Either merge 29-33 into fewer chapters or rebuild them so each chapter forces a decisive turn: revelation, commitment, institutional consequence, or irreversible relationship change. Strip out mirrored texture that does not alter the story's direction.

Ch 40–44

Problem: late pre-climax plateau | **Confidence:** 0.84
Reason: Act 4 is overall strong, but 40, 41, 43, and 44 have noticeable cheapness and moderate-to-high cut risk. They are doing setup, grief, fabrication, alliance management, and intimacy, but several of those beats appear to spread sideways instead of climbing.
Suggested fix: Reduce duplicated planning/emotional-processing scenes. Make one chapter own team assembly, one own technical readiness, one own grief/intimacy, and one own political stakes. Right now they partially overlap.

Ch 52–53

Problem: epilogue overhang | **Confidence:** 0.99
Reason: Chapter 52 gives emotional closure. Chapter 53 then introduces a separate Titus-focused sting with the single highest cut risk in the book, lowest gravity among listed tail chapters, and very high cheap drama.

Suggested fix: Either cut Chapter 53, fold its necessary information into 52 with stronger integration, or reframe it so it directly refracts Cody/Katiya's ending instead of feeling like sequel bait from another novel.

Magnitude Turns

Ch 24 — Friendly Fire

Turn: major negative descent
Reason: At M=-0.798 with high theme and energy, this is a real plunge. It looks like the story's first major proof that both protagonists can fail in ways that actually serve the premise.
Revision instruction: Strengthen setup in preceding chapters so this collapse feels inevitable rather than merely stacked. The mirrored defeats should expose the same flaw in two different systems.

Ch 31 — Heating Up

Turn: near-zero ambiguity hinge
Reason: M=-0.055 with high thematic ambiguity means a chapter is carrying meaning without clear directional vector. That can be useful, but here it sits inside a drag corridor and risks blur instead of charged uncertainty.
Revision instruction: Decide whether this chapter is a relapse or a reattachment. Push the sign of the chapter harder so readers feel a directional turn, not mush.

Ch 36 — Holding On

Turn: sign flip to positive
Reason: This is the first clear positive-magnitude beat after a long negative run, but its prominence is sharply negative and cut risk is high. Structurally, the turn matters more than the chapter currently seems to earn.
Revision instruction: Make the positive turn explicit and costly. If Cody is rediscovering care, show the choice that distinguishes this from mere mood improvement.

Ch 37 — Letting Go

Turn: false summit / ambiguous crest
Reason: Huge energy and gravity but M is basically zero. This means the chapter feels climactic while remaining directionally unresolved. That can work as a charged hinge, but it needs precise handling.
Revision instruction: Clarify what actually changes here. If this chapter is meant to break emotional deadlock before Act 4, make the new operating truth unmistakable so Chapter 38 inherits momentum instead of restarting.

Ch 38 — Bottoming Out

Turn: recovery turn into positive territory
Reason: After the ambiguity-heavy 37, this chapter moves positive. Because 37 is so large, 38 needs to feel like consequence, not another emotional low-to-high oscillation.
Revision instruction: Tighten the causal link from 37 to 38. Show how the prior revelations force a new behavior, not just a new feeling.

Ch 48 — Metanoia

Turn: late positive acceleration
Reason: M=0.688 and strong premise force. This is a crucial pre-climax turn where both protagonists finally move through pressure without self-betrayal.
Revision instruction: Emphasize contrast with earlier mirrored failures. Readers should feel that this is the corrected version of prior collapses, not just another bureaucratic obstacle chapter.

Ch 49 — Paragate

Turn: point-of-no-return convergence
Reason: M=0.855 with very high theme and low ambiguity. This is where the novel finally knows exactly what it is about.
Revision instruction: Increase finality. Make sure no subsequent chapter undercuts the sense that the protagonists have crossed from resistance into committed action.

Ch 51 — Daybreak

Turn: ultimate positive resolution
Reason: This is the decisive premise completion turn, not just a battle climax.
Revision instruction: Audit all earlier setup to ensure the symbolic and emotional components of Katiya's victory have been planted cleanly and paid off explicitly.

Cheap Heat / Low-Premise Flags

Ch 4 — Secondhand Cottage

Issue: cheap melodrama in early character setup
Reason: Cheap drama maxed at 100 with high cheap action as well, while magnitude is weak (-0.105). The trauma baseline may be genuine, but structurally it reads overheated relative to premise movement.
Revision instruction: Reduce generalized suffering display and tie the nightmare/routine material to a concrete future decision, fear pattern, or plot mechanism.

Ch 8 — Strangers To Enemies 2

Issue: loud but redundant action
Reason: Very high cheap action and high cut risk in an already repetition-prone early misunderstanding run.
Revision instruction: Trim or merge. If kept, add a new rule discovery or irreversible relational consequence so it is not just another clash.

Ch 23 — Failing To Launch

Issue: melodramatic collapse without enough thematic ballast
Reason: Cheap drama is extremely high, theme is relatively low, and cut risk is very high. It looks like one more paired failure chapter before the stronger Chapter 24 lands the real blow.

Revision instruction: Either fold the best material into Chapter 24 or sharply differentiate this chapter's failure mode so it is not pre-echoing a stronger beat.

Ch 29 — Once Lovers

Issue: cheap action and cheap drama with weak thematic return
Reason: Nearly max cheap action, very high cheap drama, high cut risk, modestly negative magnitude. This looks like relational turbulence that is not buying enough premise movement.
Revision instruction: Compress hard. Keep only the material that changes Katiya's loyalties, shame, or future decisions in a way later chapters pay off.

Ch 32 — Fantastic Modernity

Issue: high-drama low-vector chapter
Reason: M=0, high cheap drama, high cut risk. This is classic middle-book noise: colorful, emotional, but structurally noncommittal.
Revision instruction: Cut or rebuild around a decisive revelation. Tourism/novelty beats must either alter strategy or expose a core incompatibility.

Ch 41 — Annealment

Issue: late-stage cheap heat in a section that should be tightening
Reason: Max cheap action, near-max cheap drama, high cut risk, only weak positive magnitude. This suggests busywork disguised as momentum.
Revision instruction: Differentiate the Cody and Katiya threads more aggressively. One should produce concrete readiness; the other should produce concrete fracture. Right now both seem to 'harden under pressure' in generic terms.

Ch 44 — In Loving Memory

Issue: grief/intimacy inflation
Reason: High cheap drama and high cut risk despite decent positive magnitude. The chapter may be emotionally sincere, but structurally it risks overplaying mourning/intimacy beats already present nearby.
Revision instruction: Shorten and make the grief scene do plot work: a decision, alliance solidification, or change in mission posture.

Ch 50 — Knightfall

Issue: big battle energy partially outpacing theme
Reason: High gravity and solid premise force, but cheap action is also high. The chapter may be operationally exciting while slightly less precise than the chapters around it.
Revision instruction: Center the battle around the exact fear/choice pattern that Chapter 51 resolves. Make spectacle serve the trauma confrontation more directly.

Ch 53 — Threaded Echoes

Issue: sequel-bait cheap heat

Reason: Highest cut risk in the book, very high cheap drama, low gravity, and a POV shift to Titus in the final slot. This strongly suggests an attached teaser rather than an earned ending movement.
Revision instruction: Cut, move to bonus material, or integrate only if Titus has been structurally central enough to deserve the final image.

Cut Candidates

Ch 5 — Firsthand Home

Action: compress_hard
Reason: Very high cut risk, low gravity, high cheap drama, and little premise force. Feels like atmosphere and bro-hang that could be condensed.
Target: Reduce setup banter and keep only what directly motivates Cody's state when the door event matters.

Ch 8 — Strangers To Enemies 2

Action: merge
Reason: Repetitive misunderstanding conflict in an early section already overloaded with mirrored beats.
Target: Merge with adjacent clash material so the relationship escalates once instead of several times.

Ch 9 — Surprise Approach

Action: compress_hard
Reason: Very high cut risk, low gravity, weak vector, and another rationalization beat after the premise is already established.
Target: Keep Reed introduction if necessary; cut repetitive disbelief and barricade material.

Ch 12 — Anxiety and Avoidance

Action: merge
Reason: High cut risk and low structural presence; the timeskip plus crisis material may be necessary, but this chapter appears underpowered as a standalone.
Target: Fold the rescue/blame/lifeline material into a stronger adjacent chapter.

Ch 16 — Back To Business

Action: compress_hard
Reason: High cut risk, low gravity, modest premise movement. Reads like connective tissue.
Target: Keep only the father/Jackson material and any direct bridge to Cody re-engaging the cross-world plot.

Ch 23 — Failing To Launch

Action: merge
Reason: Overshadowed by Chapter 24, with high cheapness and high cut risk.
Target: Transfer the strongest failure setup into Chapter 24 and eliminate duplicated collapse beats.

Ch 29 — Once Lovers

Action: compress_hard
Reason: One of the strongest trim signals in the book: very high cheapness and high cut risk in a known drag corridor.
Target: Excise relational churn and preserve only the decision or disclosure with downstream consequence.

Ch 32 — Fantastic Modernity

Action: compress_hard
Reason: M=0, high cheap drama, high cut risk, clear middle-book stall signature.
Target: Remove novelty-tourism material unless it changes tactics or allegiance.

Ch 33 — Modern Fantasy

Action: merge
Reason: Still high cut risk after 32, with cheap action and low prominence. Feels like spillover from the same corridor.
Target: Combine with 32 or rebuild as one chapter with a sharper turn.

Ch 41 — Annealment

Action: differentiate
Reason: Late-stage chapter with extreme cheapness and substantial cut risk despite nominal forward motion.
Target: Separate the technical-build thread from the house-secrets thread so the chapter earns its existence through contrast, not blur.

Ch 44 — In Loving Memory

Action: trim
Reason: Emotionally plausible but structurally redundant with neighboring grief/intimacy/planning chapters.
Target: Shorten mourning beats and intensify mission or relational consequence.

Ch 53 — Threaded Echoes

Action: keep
Reason: Near-certain overhang: highest cut risk, lowest tail gravity, off-axis POV, sequel-hook feel.
Target: Keep only if this is book-one-in-series architecture and Titus has sufficient prior structural weight; otherwise cut entirely or relocate outside the main ending.

Chapter-by-Chapter Notes

Ch 1 — Strangers To Enemies 1

Reason: Strong opener conceptually, but make sure the initial wonder also establishes the novel's actual vector, not just its hook.
Note: Strong opener conceptually, but make sure the initial wonder also establishes the novel's actual vector, not just its hook.

Ch 2 — The Knight Before

Reason: Katiya intro likely needs tightening; it currently looks more ambient than structurally necessary.
Note: Katiya intro likely needs tightening; it currently looks more ambient than structurally necessary.

Ch 3 — The Day After

Reason: Office malaise is probably overrepresented this early.
Note: Office malaise is probably overrepresented this early.

Ch 4 — Secondhand Cottage

Reason: Keep trauma baseline, reduce overheated presentation and generic routine.
Note: Keep trauma baseline, reduce overheated presentation and generic routine.

Ch 5 — Firsthand Home

Reason: Too much low-yield Cody atmosphere.
Note: Too much low-yield Cody atmosphere.

Ch 6 — Insurgency

Reason: Probably worth keeping for first collision escalation, but sharpen causal stakes.
Note: Probably worth keeping for first collision escalation, but sharpen causal stakes.

Ch 7 — Exfiltration

Reason: Mirror replay chapter; preserve only what Katiya's perspective newly reveals.
Note: Mirror replay chapter; preserve only what Katiya's perspective newly reveals.

Ch 8 — Strangers To Enemies 2

Reason: Redundant clash energy.
Note: Redundant clash energy.

Ch 9 — Surprise Approach

Reason: Belief-resistance is overstaying.
Note: Belief-resistance is overstaying.

Ch 10 — Strategic Retreat

Reason: Big emotional damage chapter, but trim melodrama and clarify consequence.

Note: Big emotional damage chapter, but trim melodrama and clarify consequence.

Ch 11 — Ennui and Excoriation

Reason: Useful setup for Cody's stagnation, but likely longer than needed.
Note: Useful setup for Cody's stagnation, but likely longer than needed.

Ch 12 — Anxiety and Avoidance

Reason: Reads like bridge material rather than a chapter that earns stand-alone weight.
Note: Reads like bridge material rather than a chapter that earns stand-alone weight.

Ch 13 — The Sleeping Knight

Reason: Important relational hinge; protect the humane core.
Note: Important relational hinge; protect the humane core.

Ch 14 — Luddite By Chance

Reason: Good fish-out-of-water content, but compress novelty beats.
Note: Good fish-out-of-water content, but compress novelty beats.

Ch 15 — Technophile By Choice

Reason: Touring/social integration should not sprawl.
Note: Touring/social integration should not sprawl.

Ch 16 — Back To Business

Reason: Connective tissue.
Note: Connective tissue.

Ch 17 — Onward To Chaos

Reason: Solid Katiya-forward chapter if it keeps pressure active.
Note: Solid Katiya-forward chapter if it keeps pressure active.

Ch 18 — Civillian Combat

Reason: Character beat with low vector; keep only if later payoff is explicit.
Note: Character beat with low vector; keep only if later payoff is explicit.

Ch 19 — Warrior Business

Reason: Likely useful world-linking material, but too light structurally.
Note: Likely useful world-linking material, but too light structurally.

Ch 20 — Domestic Relations
Reason: Parallel date misfire material risks mirrored redundancy.
Note: Parallel date misfire material risks mirrored redundancy.

Ch 21 — Foreign Affairs
Reason: Better relational strain chapter; likely more useful than 20.
Note: Better relational strain chapter; likely more useful than 20.

Ch 22 — Losing To Fear
Reason: Pre-failure loading seems useful.
Note: Pre-failure loading seems useful.

Ch 23 — Failing To Launch
Reason: Overshadowed by the stronger failure chapter immediately after.
Note: Overshadowed by the stronger failure chapter immediately after.

Ch 24 — Friendly Fire
Reason: Key structural drop. Do not blunt it.
Note: Key structural drop. Do not blunt it.

Ch 25 — A House Divided
Reason: Strong aftermath chapter; just ensure it is not repeating the same collapse emotionally.
Note: Strong aftermath chapter; just ensure it is not repeating the same collapse emotionally.

Ch 26 — Cold War
Reason: Powerful mass, but needs clearer linkage to present vector so flashback energy is not semi-detached.
Note: Powerful mass, but needs clearer linkage to present vector so flashback energy is not semi-detached.

Ch 27 — Warm Solitude
Reason: Core trauma payload for Katiya's arc.
Note: Core trauma payload for Katiya's arc.

Ch 28 — Prometheus
Reason: Useful Cody ignition chapter; maintain if later JAX/payoff directly cashes it.
Note: Useful Cody ignition chapter; maintain if later JAX/payoff directly cashes it.

Ch 29 — Once Lovers

Reason: Strong trim target.
Note: Strong trim target.

Ch 30 — Cold Sweat

Reason: High-theme premise chapter; worth preserving if sharpened.
Note: High-theme premise chapter; worth preserving if sharpened.

Ch 31 — Heating Up

Reason: Needs a clearer directional identity.
Note: Needs a clearer directional identity.

Ch 32 — Fantastic Modernity

Reason: Prime middle-book stall chapter.
Note: Prime middle-book stall chapter.

Ch 33 — Modern Fantasy

Reason: Likely belongs fused with surrounding material.
Note: Likely belongs fused with surrounding material.

Ch 34 — Professional Death

Reason: Essential Cody collapse chapter.
Note: Essential Cody collapse chapter.

Ch 35 — Physical Demise

Reason: Essential Katiya collapse chapter.
Note: Essential Katiya collapse chapter.

Ch 36 — Holding On

Reason: Important sign flip, but under-earn it more clearly.
Note: Important sign flip, but under-earn it more clearly.

Ch 37 — Letting Go

Reason: Huge chapter, but clarify its vector so it does not feel like empty largeness.
Note: Huge chapter, but clarify its vector so it does not feel like empty largeness.

Ch 38 — Bottoming Out

Reason: Needed recovery hinge, but tie it tightly to 37.
Note: Needed recovery hinge, but tie it tightly to 37.

Ch 39 — Crossing Over
Reason: Good widening chapter, though still somewhat ambiguous.
Note: Good widening chapter, though still somewhat ambiguous.

Ch 40 — Reaching Up
Reason: Planning material should be leaner and less overlap-heavy.
Note: Planning material should be leaner and less overlap-heavy.

Ch 41 — Annealment
Reason: Busy and blurry; assign more distinct work to each protagonist thread.
Note: Busy and blurry; assign more distinct work to each protagonist thread.

Ch 42 — Eutectic Point
Reason: Useful expansion chapter if it cleanly feeds 49-51.
Note: Useful expansion chapter if it cleanly feeds 49-51.

Ch 43 — Harsh Noise
Reason: Hope/fabrication/alliance stress likely needs pruning.
Note: Hope/fabrication/alliance stress likely needs pruning.

Ch 44 — In Loving Memory
Reason: Shorten grief/intimacy repetition.
Note: Shorten grief/intimacy repetition.

Ch 45 — In Future Grief
Reason: Strong late emotional/premise alignment chapter.
Note: Strong late emotional/premise alignment chapter.

Ch 46 — Close Quarters
Reason: Strong but somewhat overheated; refine rather than cut.
Note: Strong but somewhat overheated; refine rather than cut.

Ch 47 — Ground Control
Reason: Necessary institutional squeeze chapter; make sure it has enough propulsion.
Note: Necessary institutional squeeze chapter; make sure it has enough propulsion.

Ch 48 — Metanoia
Reason: Critical pre-climax correction chapter.

Note: Critical pre-climax correction chapter.

Ch 49 — Paragate
Reason: Core convergence chapter.
Note: Core convergence chapter.

Ch 50 — Knightfall
Reason: Big battle chapter; make sure spectacle is chained to theme.
Note: Big battle chapter; make sure spectacle is chained to theme.

Ch 51 — Daybreak
Reason: The summit.
Note: The summit.

Ch 52 — Parasmagate
Reason: This appears to be the real ending. Protect closure.
Note: This appears to be the real ending. Protect closure.

Ch 53 — Threaded Echoes
Reason: Only keep if you can justify why this book, after landing, should end on Titus rather than on the earned double-protagonist closure.
Note: Only keep if you can justify why this book, after landing, should end on Titus rather than on the earned double-protagonist closure.

Next Revision Pass

- Compress Act 1 aggressively, especially chapters 2-9. The mirror structure is established too many times before it begins compounding.
- Audit every dual-protagonist chapter for non-overlap. In each paired chapter, Cody and Katiya should not be doing emotional equivalents unless the symmetry itself creates a new insight or consequence.
- Rebuild the 29-33 corridor as a sharper escalation run. Cut tourism, relational churn, and novelty beats that do not change the vector.
- Clarify ambiguous high-energy chapters near zero magnitude, especially 31 and 37. Big scenes need directional meaning, not just intensity.
- Make the sign flip around 36-38 cleaner. The transition from negative spiral to positive mobilization should feel causal and earned.
- Tighten late Act 4 setup chapters 40-44 so they climb instead of plateau. Remove duplicated planning, grief processing, and team-bonding beats.
- Increase setup/payoff linkage from 24/27/34/35 into 48/49/51. The climax is strong; make earlier wounds and failures feed it even more explicitly.
- Evaluate whether Chapter 53 belongs in the novel at all. If it stays, integrate Titus earlier or make the final sting directly refract the book's central premise rather than feeling bolted on.

Full Chapter / Unit Table

Ch	Chapter	A	D	T	M	E	PF	G	Cut	POV	Summary
1	Strangers To Enemies 1	4.9	5.1	7.7	-0.09	17.7	-0.7	35.6	42.7	Cody	Cody celebrates his first home, drunkenly stumbles through the adjoining door into another world, is healed by strangers, and fixates on the "cosplayer" girl on the other side.
2	The Knight Before	2.3	5.4	5.7	+0.07	13.4	+0.4	11.2	80.2	Katiya	Katiya's intro: she struggles to relax, Aldrin frames trainee expectations, and she reconnects with Jullian as they "christen" her new place.
3	The Day After	3.8	5.8	5.2	+0.03	14.8	+0.2	8.8	82.7	Cody	Cody's bleak office day: roasted for late redlines, awkward beat with Kei, then family unpacking with Miguel queued up for drinks.
4	Secondhand Cottage	5.5	7.1	4.5	-0.10	17.2	-0.5	15.8	82.1	Katiya	Katiya's trauma baseline: nightmares of Hillfar; she self-stabilizes, starts her day, meets Derry & Carmen (Rayna foreshadow), and heads to base with Bertram.
5	Firsthand Home	2.6	6.8	5.1	-0.05	14.5	-0.2	10.2	84.9	Cody	Cody + Miguel bro out, drink hard; Miguel crashes, Cody stays up.
6	Insurgency	5.4	6.7	5.8	-0.14	17.9	-0.8	22.9	67.2	Katiya	Katiya's first day ends in panic when a distant light (Firebrand tie-in) appears; town responds; on returning home she finds an intruder—Cody— ambushes him.
7	Exfiltration	4.6	5.0	6.0	-0.06	15.6	-0.4	12.4	72.2	Katiya	Prologue re-seen through Katiya: she crosses into the modern world and recoils, landing back through the door—mirror of Cody's intro.
8	Strangers To Enemies 2	5.7	3.3	5.0	-0.10	14.0	-0.5	6.7	88.4	Katiya	Third clash: Katiya (assuming Auvryan

Ch	Chapter	A	D	T	M	E	PF	G	Cut	POV	Summary
											assassin) and Cody fight to another misunderstanding; she drives him back through the door.
9	Surprise Approach	4.5	4.4	4.8	-0.07	13.7	-0.3	8.3	89.6	Cody	Cody tries to rationalize it away (no wound); barricades the door; nearly late to work; meets foil Reed.
10	Strategic Retreat	5.9	8.4	6.1	-0.46	20.4	-2.8	34.7	54.4	Katiya	Katiya cleans to stave off panic, studies Cody's device; time skip: a month later she hesitates during a royal escort, barely averts disaster, is berated, and runs to find Bertram.
11	Ennui and Excoriation	3.9	6.5	6.4	-0.18	16.8	-1.1	25.4	63.0	Cody	Another month later: Cody is bored while Reed earns praise; Nav spins up a new project; Cody ghosts social invites, but hears pleading through the door at home.
12	Anxiety and Avoidance	3.6	3.9	5.3	-0.09	12.8	-0.5	11.2	85.8	Katiya	FOUR WEEK TIME SKIPKatiya, Ryder, and Paxton rescue near-dead Bertram; she's blamed and shut out—her only remaining lifeline is Cody.
13	The Sleeping Knight	5.1	7.2	6.2	-0.55	18.6	-3.4	28.8	59.4	Cody, Katiya	Katiya crosses mid-panic; Cody calms her and lets her sleep; awkward breakfast; they agree to "no interfering" (both intend to break it).
14	Luddite By Chance	4.3	4.8	6.2	-0.37	15.4	-2.3	16.6	69.0	Cody, Katiya	Cody gives her a gentle orientation day: first car ride (terrifying), Costco errand gauntlet—Katiya is overwhelmed by the future.
15	Technophile By Choice	4.3	5.8	5.7	-0.17	15.8	-1.0	19.3	73.6	Cody, Katiya	Cody runs Katiya's route in Gaffesend; she tours him as "royal inventor"; awkward Jullian moment; tavern hang where Cody fits in.
16	Back To Business	3.4	5.2	5.3	-0.18	13.9	-1.0	13.2	82.3	Cody	Cody's spark flickers: nostalgia and lunch with Alan (Jackson talk); he

Ch	Chapter	A	D	T	M	E	PF	G	Cut	POV	Summary
											returns hoping for an open door.
17	Onward To Chaos	6.3	6.0	6.8	-0.37	19.2	-2.5	34.1	51.1	Katiya	Katiya visits Bertram in the hospital (promises Hillfar); market duty goes sideways; she chases and collars Rayna (Ahkvasan half-blood); Jullian downplays her leap; Cody leaves a treat.
18	Civillian Combat	4.7	5.5	6.1	-0.01	16.3	-0.1	24.0	66.8	Cody	Cody's volunteer training day: Katiya teases, his mistake catches Aldrin's eye; later he chooses friendship over victory in a challenge—character beat.
19	Warrior Business	3.9	5.2	6.0	-0.17	15.0	-1.0	20.4	73.0	Katiya	Open house at Cody's work: meet Reed & Kei; Cody geeks out, Katiya meets Alan & Kim; they overhear Reed/Kei on Cody missing from the "Future Talent" wall.
20	Domestic Relations	4.1	6.3	5.6	-0.26	16.0	-1.5	24.0	72.6	Cody, Katiya	Katiya engineers a Cody—Kei date; in parallel she and Jullian go to hot springs and bristle; Cody's date feels off and foggy—he insists he's "fine."
21	Foreign Affairs	4.9	7.4	6.5	-0.35	18.9	-2.3	35.9	54.0	Katiya, Cody	Katiya extracts an uncomfortable truth from Jullian; intercut meltdown date beats (both couples misfire); Cody & Kei hook up but it lands as empty.
22	Losing To Fear	4.1	6.5	6.4	-0.44	17.0	-2.8	35.0	60.6	Katiya, Cody	Katiya passes core exams but shoots poorly; Aryn is unflappable; Cody and Reed clash about what a Level-1 is; Katiya insists on leading the next team exam, feeling off her game.
23	Failing To Launch	4.8	6.7	4.6	-0.28	16.1	-1.3	38.5	78.5	Cody, Katiya	Cody presents and gets hammered; Reed's allies redirect the room; Katiya's plan withers,

Ch	Chapter	A	D	T	M	E	PF	G	Cut	POV	Summary
											Bertram is "killed" in exercise, she barges the opposing house—bad optics.
24	Friendly Fire	7.8	7.2	8.0	-0.80	23.0	-6.4	73.9	22.2	Cody, Katiya	Reed's presentation wins; Cody's mild critique is spun as jealousy and he snaps publicly; Katiya loses to Aryn, is told she's below the line, and learns her family's already in Gaffesend.
25	A House Divided	6.3	7.6	7.1	-0.71	21.0	-5.1	78.0	32.9	Cody, Katiya	Cody spirals home; Katiya waits on his couch; their mutual failures ignite a bitter fight—door slammed shut again.
26	Cold War	8.6	7.4	7.5	-0.23	23.4	-1.7	90.3	20.9	Cody	Jackson's "Operation Bluewings" flashback: drone crash, mission abort, and his sacrificial call to Overwatch in the storm.
27	Warm Solitude	7.3	7.6	7.8	-0.61	22.8	-4.8	79.8	21.8	Katiya	Katiya's origin trauma: childhood game ? treehouse collapse ? Raph's death; she hides in a corpse pit; the Chymaeran lie brands her forever.
28	Prometheus	6.1	6.0	6.6	-0.50	18.8	-3.3	57.1	49.0	Cody	Months later: Naveen notes Cody's improvement but deeper ennui; company lunch where Reed is promoted; Reed asks Cody to help fix his flawed prototype (they bond); that night Cody, riding the high, uses Essence as flux—batteries "fire" and spark his next idea.
29	Once Lovers	6.5	6.0	4.6	-0.36	17.1	-1.6	43.4	74.9	Katiya, Cody	
30	Cold Sweat	4.6	6.4	8.3	-0.67	19.3	-5.6	46.7	33.8	Katiya, Cody	
31	Heating Up	5.8	5.5	6.8	-0.06	18.2	-0.4	37.1	52.5	Katiya, Cody	
32	Fantastic Modernity	4.0	6.4	4.6	+0.00	14.9	+0.0	25.7	85.1	Katiya, Cody	

Ch	Chapter	A	D	T	M	E	PF	G	Cut	POV	Summary
33	Modern Fantasy	6.1	4.6	5.5	-0.17	16.2	-0.9	36.6	70.2	Cody, Katiya	
34	Professional Death	6.8	8.0	8.0	-0.80	22.9	-6.5	67.4	22.4	Cody	
35	Physical Demise	7.3	8.4	7.2	-0.72	22.9	-5.1	75.4	29.3	Katiya	
36	Holding On	4.6	5.1	5.3	+0.11	15.1	+0.6	49.0	70.8	Cody	
37	Letting Go	6.1	9.2	8.8	-0.02	24.1	-0.2	80.1	10.9	Katiya, Cody	
38	Bottoming Out	5.7	7.4	6.0	+0.19	19.1	+1.2	60.5	51.1	Cody, Katiya	After reaching the ugliest versions of themselves, Cody and Katiya finally stop performing strength and let each other see the damage. Cody interrupts his own collapse long enough to comfort Katiya after Bertram's death, and Katiya's tribunal summons turns grief into a hard deadline. By the end of the chapter, despair has not lifted—but it has been given direction.
39	Crossing Over	6.8	7.9	7.0	+0.21	21.7	+1.5	65.8	36.7	Cody, Katiya	The private crisis inside Katiya's house becomes part of a much larger war when Titus and Sylvia force their way into the story. Cody is thrown into a terrifying first encounter with people from a harsher world, Katiya begins to understand the scale of what is coming, and Cody's attempt to regroup turns into a brutal training date that recommits him to fighting for a future instead of grieving one he already lost.
40	Reaching Up	5.7	6.1	5.9	+0.34	17.6	+2.0	43.0	62.4	Katiya, Cody	The planning phase begins in earnest as Cody's world and Katiya's world stop operating like separate emotional shelters. Over coffee, cheap drinks, and overlapping stories, the group starts building a shared strategy. Cody's abandoned project stops being a joke, and Katiya's

Ch	Chapter	A	D	T	M	E	PF	G	Cut	POV	Summary
											increasingly unstable home life collides with the possibility that her estranged allies might actually stand with her.
41	Annealment	6.7	7.2	4.6	+0.16	18.5	+0.7	42.9	72.3	Cody, Katiya	Action replaces vague intention. Cody begins rebuilding JAX with help instead of shame, while Katiya tries to hold together a house full of secrets, fugitives, and divided loyalties. Both storylines harden under pressure: Cody through labor, Katiya through deception and risk.
42	Eutectic Point	5.7	5.7	7.0	+0.43	18.4	+3.0	42.0	50.4	Katiya, Cody	The story widens. Katiya is introduced to Aliaki, Jade, and the deeper political reality behind the coming attack, while Cody is invited deeper into Reed's privileged world and closer to a genuine second chance at proving himself. Both protagonists are handed tools and warnings they only partly understand.
43	Harsh Noise	5.7	7.6	6.0	+0.35	19.3	+2.1	49.1	55.6	Cody, Katiya	Hope starts making noise. Cody begins fabrication in Reed's family machine space and gains the first meaningful encouragement he has felt from adults tied to the aerospace legacy he still wants. Meanwhile, Katiya's alliance nearly implodes in a misunderstanding fueled by power and distrust, forcing her to stabilize a group that could either save Gaffesend or tear itself apart.
44	In Loving Memory	5.0	7.7	5.4	+0.37	18.0	+2.0	50.6	63.5	Cody, Katiya	Grief finally becomes communal instead of private. Cody helps Aryn and Rayna speak through loss by talking about Jackson, Katiya returns to a quieter house and finds evidence of the care he has

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											extended to others, and the chapter ends with intimacy growing out of exhaustion, trust, and shared mourning.
45	In Future Grief	6.3	7.9	7.7	+0.54	21.8	+4.1	68.4	29.4	Cody, Katiya	Both protagonists face family systems that love them but do not really understand what they are choosing. Cody confronts his parents' fear, finances, and assumptions about his future, while Katiya tells her family the truth about the danger she still intends to face. Jackson's name and memory become fused to Cody's project, turning invention into memorial.
46	Close Quarters	7.0	8.5	6.5	+0.42	22.0	+2.7	71.2	38.7	Katiya	The quiet before the storm turns out not to be quiet at all. Cody and Katiya field-test the prototype and accidentally unleash terrifying power, then return home to find official pressure closing around Katiya's life. Their last stretch of peace becomes a vow, a confession, and an act of choosing each other before the worlds move to tear them apart.
47	Ground Control	5.9	6.1	6.6	+0.27	18.7	+1.8	63.1	47.2	Cody, Katiya	Cody and Katiya each step into what should be their final chance to claim the futures they want, only to be immediately restrained by the institutions they have spent the story trying to survive. Cody tries to reach the Aspen conference room before HR can bury him, while Katiya is taken into custody before her tribunal and shut away from the threat she knows is coming. By the end of the chapter, both are trapped inside systems that mistake control for safety.

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48	Metanoia	6.0	6.9	7.3	+0.69	20.3	+5.0	69.4	35.3	Cody, Katiya	Both protagonists fight for one clean chance to be heard. Cody's confession turns his firing into a political problem inside Navidson-Monroe, while Katiya persuades Aryn that the truth matters more than procedure and turns imprisonment into a joint push toward Aldrin. The chapter tests what they have actually learned: not how to escape pressure, but how to move through it without lying to themselves.
49	Paragate	6.4	6.9	8.6	+0.85	21.9	+7.3	82.0	17.2	Katiya, Cody	The true conflict of Paragate begins as witness replaces doubt and preparation replaces denial. Aldrin sees enough to gamble on Katiya, while Cody leaves Navidson-Monroe uncertain of what his honesty has bought him but sure he is not done yet. Both protagonists step fully into the roles they have been resisting, and the story pivots from argument into mobilization.
50	Knightfall	7.7	6.3	6.5	+0.58	20.5	+3.8	80.1	38.2	Cody, Katiya	The battle turns when Cody is the first to notice movement across the frozen lake and realizes the defense is pointed the wrong way. As the first line is held by powers and allies beyond the core cast, the real threat reveals itself as a coordinated strike against the city itself. Katiya is forced into the exact shape of the nightmare that made her who she is, and Cody refuses to leave her to face it entirely alone.
51	Daybreak	8.1	8.9	9.0	+0.90	26.0	+8.1	91.4	0.0	Katiya	Katiya confronts the living shape of her oldest trauma and proves that what she has learned is stronger than fear. As Nhytyx recreates the emotional architecture of

Ch	Chapter	A	D	T	M	E	PF	G	Cut	POV	Summary
											the nightmare that once broke her, Katiya saves her family through action instead of paralysis, while Cody disobeys her only enough to make one small but crucial difference. At dawn, Katiya completes her arc not just by surviving the past, but by replacing it with a new public truth.
52	Parasmagate	3.0	6.8	7.5	+0.32	17.3	+2.4	42.4	48.7	Cody, Default	The epilogue gives Paragate its emotional closure before leaving one quiet fracture open for the future. Cody and Katiya emerge from the battle changed, no longer using each other's worlds as refuge from their own lives, and their relationship finally rests on chosen commitment instead of mutual escape.
53	Threaded Echoes	2.6	5.8	4.6	+0.40	13.0	+1.8	5.4	99.9	Default	